



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Love stories aren't always easy ...



Learning Outcome

Describe complicated or unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Have you ever had a big argument with someone? What was it about?
- Which famous love stories do you know? Do they usually have a happy ending?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about feelings and sensations.
- I can talk about things I have done or have been doing.
- I can show I understand someone's feelings or situation.





Let's Explore!

Paula tells her friend about how her parents met.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Paula:** Hi Peter, how are you doing?
Peter: Hi Paula, I'm happy because I'm on holiday. How are you?
Paula: I'm excited. My parents' 50th anniversary party is tonight. I've been planning it for over two months now.
Peter: Wow, 50 years! That's amazing!
Paula: Yes, in fact, the story is even more amazing when you consider the wedding almost never happened. Have I told you that story?
Peter: No! Please do. I haven't heard it yet.
Paula: My father is Italian, and my mother is American. They met while she was traveling in Italy. She was so enthralled with him, she stayed three weeks longer than planned.
Peter: It sounds so romantic. I've watched many movies set in Italy.
Paula: They fell madly in love, but their parents didn't accept the idea of marrying someone from so far away who had a different culture, language and religion. They were very annoyed.
Peter: This story is fascinating! It sounds like Romeo and Juliet.
Paula: It is. My mother had a big argument with my grandmother. Of course, it made my mother feel miserable. She was so disappointed. My father was depressed because she wasn't allowed to write to him. He had a broken heart.
Peter: That's so sad. I wish family members didn't behave like this.
Paula: Yes, it was quite upsetting for both of them.
Peter: What happened?
Paula: I wish I had time to finish the story now, but I have to go now! Sorry!
Peter: Paula!!



Let's Practice!

Paula talks about what she has been doing lately!

Instructions: Draw a line to match the sentences in Column A and Column B. When you complete the sentences, read the sentences aloud with your partner. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

COLUMN A

1. I've been planning it
2. I've watched many
3. They have seen each other
4. I haven't
5. Have I told

COLUMN B

- a. finished the story yet.
- b. many times since then.
- c. you that story?
- d. for over two months now.
- e. movies set in Italy.



Let's Practice!

Peter wishes that he was more romantic!

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. wish / another / I / one / were / of / parents / my / country / . / from

2. time / finish / I / wish / . / the / to / had / story / I

3. married / . / first / I / my / I / love / had / wish

4. I / Europe / I / wish / to / and / in / had / love / traveled / . / fallen

5. romantic / . / more / I / were / you / wish





Extension Activity

Writing for a soap opera.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a 12 to 15 line script for a soap opera.
- Set the scene.
- One of the female characters is making dinner for her boyfriend.
- Explain what she has done already.

Role play with a partner.

- The girl's mother comes over to the apartment.
- She doesn't like her daughter's boyfriend.
- The daughter doesn't want her mother to know about the date.
- The mother is suspicious and asks a lot of questions using the present perfect and present perfect continuous.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about feelings and sensations.

☐ ☐

I talk about things I have done or have been doing.

☐ ☐

I show I understand someone's feelings or situation.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **anniversary** (noun): day of the year when two people were married
e.g. My parent's 50th anniversary party is tonight.
- **wedding** (noun): ceremony uniting two people in marriage
e.g. The story is even more amazing when you consider the wedding almost never happened.
- **enthralled** (adjective): spellbound; enchanted; captivated
e.g. She was so enthralled with him, she stayed three weeks longer than planned.
- **argument** (noun): conflictual communication between two or more people
e.g. My mother had a big argument with my grandmother.
- **upsetting** (adjective): describes something that makes you feel angry
e.g. It was quite upsetting for both of them.
- **miserable** (noun): terrible; awful
e.g. It made my mother feel miserable.





Learning Points

Show You Understand Someone's Feelings or Situation

It is common to show you understand someone's feelings in a conversation. You use "*I wish ...* " to talk about things you do not have or do, or you cannot have or do.

The verb *wish* introduces an idea. After *wish*, you use a verb in the past tense.

I wish I knew ...
I wish I had ...
I wish you were ...

Structure:

Wish + Simple Past tense

Example	Meaning
<i>I wish family members didn't behave like this.</i>	I'd like family members to behave differently, but they don't.
<i>I wish I had time to finish the story now.</i>	I'd like to finish the story now, but I can't.





Learning Points

Present Perfect Continuous vs. Present Perfect Tense

You use these tenses to express that an action began in the past and is still going on or has just finished.

You use the *Present Perfect tense* mainly to express that an action is completed or to emphasize the result.

Forms:

Regular verbs: form of *have* + base form of verb + *-ed*

Example: I've watched many movies set in Italy.

Irregular verbs: form of *have* + past participle of irregular verbs

Example: I haven't heard the story yet.

You use the *Present Perfect Continuous tense* to emphasize the duration or continuous course of an action.

Form:

Form of *have* + *been* + base form of verb + *-ing*

Example: I've been planning the party for two months.

Subject	has/have	been	verb+ing
I	have	been	planning the activity for 2 months.
I	have	been	planning the party since August.

- You use **FOR** to talk about how long an action has been happening (a week, 2 days, five hours, six years etc.)
- You use **SINCE** to talk about when the action started (2010, Monday, August)

Examples:

- **Ann:** *I've been planning a party for my parents. Have I told you the story of how they met?*
- **Bob:** *No. I haven't heard it yet.*

